

0.2 The need for Psychological Science

Vocab

Common Sense

Things that seem "Obvious" despite a lack of scientific inquiry

Hindsight Bias

The tendency to believe that one would have foreseen an outcome after it occurred

Overconfidence

Our tendency to assume we know more than we do.

Superforecaster

2% of people; excel at predicting social outcomes

Pattern - seeking

Our tendency to seek order where there is none, typically in fear of unpredictability

MCQs

1. b 2. c 3. b 4. c 5. c

Critical thinking > Common Sense

repetition of information will increase believability regardless of how true it is

Hindsight Bias

No one's diary recorded, "Today the Hundred Years War Began"

People believe that they would have foreseen an event after its outcome

Common Sense describes what already happened better than it predicts what will happen

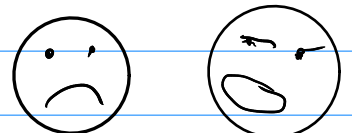
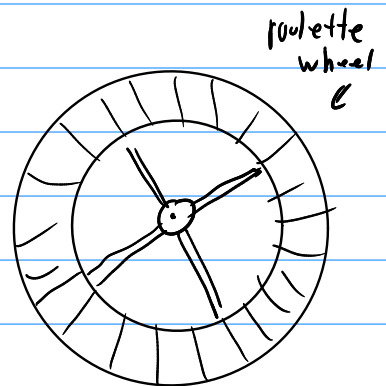
> 800 scholarly papers demonstrate Hindsight bias

Why are we so over confident?

Tetlock's Experiment

Tetlock collected >27K predictions of world events. Experts were ~80% confident but were <40% right.

He found that only 2% of people excel at predicting social behaviour, dubbing them "superforecasters."



Putting it all on black was so dumb!
I knew you should have put it on red!

Personal Connection:

I used to look at most historical events, and think it was obvious that something was a bad decision. Now I see why I might be wrong

Why do we see order in randomness?

Random sequences often appear to have some order

Our eagerness to make sense of the world lends itself to these illusions

For many, the inherent unpredictability of the world creates a fear that can only be solved with patterns that are not real.

Fun fact

When embezzlers try stealing money, their artificially 'extra-random' patterns can alert fraud experts

"The really unusual day is one where nothing unusual happens." - Statistician Persi Diaconis

Summary

